

GHOULS: SPECIES VARIANTS

GHOULS: SPECIES VARIANTS IS A MONSTER supplement for 5e that expands the classic ghoul into a range of corpse-born predators drawn from many peoples and monstrous bodies. Instead of relying on a single ghoul stat block repeated across encounters, this book presents a structured roster of cannibal undead whose hunting styles are shaped by the anatomy they once possessed.

The intent of this product is encounter variety without mechanical escalation. Each ghoul uses the standard ghoul chassis—preserving the expected damage, paralysis mechanics, and threat level—while retaining exactly one anatomical trait from its former species. Dense dwarven frames resist forced movement, long-limbed bugbears strike from greater reach, aquatic merfolk ghouls hunt beneath the waves, and massive giant corpses become towering engines of hunger.

These creatures are not masterminds of undeath. They are driven by instinct, starvation, and the lingering echoes of predatory anatomy. Their shared doctrine reflects this brutal simplicity: they are compelled toward fresh corpses, fixate on paralyzed prey, and lunge forward in bursts of feeding frenzy when hunger overwhelms restraint.

Ghouls appear wherever death accumulates faster than the living can bury it:

- Plague pits and mass graves where bodies rot beneath thin soil.
- Battlefields where the fallen lie unburned and unblest.
- Necromantic territories where dark magic seeps into the dead.
- Ruined settlements where starvation and violence have taken root.

Most ghouls behave like the predators they once resembled in life, but stripped of reason and magnified by endless hunger. Smaller ghouls swarm the weak and fallen while larger corpse-beasts tear through the living in pursuit of flesh.

While a single ghoul can be terrifying, their true danger appears when many gather. Packs of corpse-eaters spread across a battlefield, dragging down prey through paralysis and overwhelming numbers before descending into a frenzy of feeding.

Use these monsters to turn ordinary graveyards, battlefields, and cursed wilderness into hunting grounds of ravenous undead. Populate necromancer domains with feral servants, fill plague-ridden cities with corpse-eaters, or show how the corruption of death spreads when the dead are left unburied.

Where one ghoul feeds, others soon follow.

GHOULS LADDER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Human Ghoul	1	Baseline corpse-feeder whose claws paralyze prey before the pack descends.
Dwarf Ghoul	1	Dense-boned predator resistant to forced movement that crushes prey through brute persistence.
Elf Ghoul	1	Wall-climbing corpse hunter that stalks prey from ceilings and high ground.
Halfling Ghoul	1	Compact ghoul that slips through tight spaces to ambush the vulnerable.
Gnome Ghoul	1	Small but unnervingly resilient ghoul that resists magical influence.
Ratfolk Ghoul	1	Sewer-adapted crawler that bursts from walls and tunnels to seize prey.
Goblin Ghoul	1	Nimble corpse-eater that darts between enemies before striking.
Hobgoblin Ghoul	1	Rigid, relentless ghoul that presses forward alongside other undead.
Orc Ghoul	1	Brutal flesh-ripper that refuses to fall until its prey is dead.
Gnoll Ghoul	1	Frenzied carrion hunter that surges forward when a creature falls.
Bugbear Ghoul	1	Long-limbed ambusher whose reach lets it snatch prey from surprising distance.
Merfolk Ghoul	1	Aquatic corpse predator that hunts beneath dark waters.
Lizardfolk Ghoul	1	Thick-scaled swamp ghoul with resilient hide and savage bite.
Dragonborn Ghoul	1	Draconic corpse-frame whose ruined breath glands still exhale deadly energy.
Ogre Ghoul	3	Massive corpse brute that tears through the living with overwhelming strength.
Minotaur Ghoul	4	Charging undead war-beast that tramples prey before devouring it.
Troll Ghoul	5	Regenerating cannibal horror that reforms unless burned or dissolved.
Hill Giant Ghoul	7	Colossal corpse predator that smashes through lines in search of flesh.

GNOLL GHOUL

Medium undead, chaotic evil

Armor Class 12

Hit Points 22 (5d8)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)	7 (-2)	10 (+0)	6 (-2)

Damage Immunities poison

Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, poisoned

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 10

Languages understands Gnoll but can't speak

Challenge 1 (200 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Carrion Frenzy. When a creature within 30 feet of this ghoul drops to 0 hit points, the gnoll ghoul can move up to half its speed toward that creature as a reaction.

Predatory Doctrine. If a paralyzed creature is within reach, this ghoul always targets that creature with its claw attack.

Compulsive Feeder. If a corpse that died within the last minute is visible within 30 feet and not actively defended, this ghoul must succeed on a DC 10 Wisdom saving throw at the start of its turn or move toward the corpse by the most direct route. If it reaches the corpse, it uses its action to feed and regains 2 hit points.

ACTIONS

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 9 (2d6 + 2) piercing damage.

Claws. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (2d4 + 2) slashing damage. If the target is a creature other than an elf or undead, it must succeed on a DC 10 Constitution saving throw or be paralyzed for 1 minute. The target repeats the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on a success.

Hungry Lunge (Recharge 5–6). The gnoll ghoul moves up to half its speed without provoking opportunity attacks. If it ends this movement adjacent to a paralyzed, incapacitated, or unconscious creature, it makes one claw attack against that creature.

- This ghoul becomes frenzied when creatures fall nearby.
- It abandons positioning and rushes corpses the moment they appear.
- Packs of these ghouls can create sudden feeding rushes during battle.



BUGBEAR GHOUL

Medium undead, chaotic evil

Armor Class 12

Hit Points 27 (5d8 + 5)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	7 (-2)	10 (+0)	6 (-2)

Skills Stealth +4

Damage Immunities poison

Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, poisoned

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 10

Languages understands Goblin but can't speak

Challenge 1 (200 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Long-Limbed Frame. This ghoul's melee attacks have a reach of 10 feet.

Predatory Doctrine. If a paralyzed creature is within reach, this ghoul always targets that creature with its claw attack.

Compulsive Feeder. If a corpse that died within the last minute is visible within 30 feet and not actively defended, this ghoul must succeed on a DC 10 Wisdom saving throw at the start of its turn or move toward the corpse by the most direct route. If it reaches the corpse, it uses its action to feed and regains 2 hit points.

ACTIONS

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 9 (2d6 + 2) piercing damage.

Claws. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (2d4 + 2) slashing damage. If the target is a creature other than an elf or undead, it must succeed on a DC 10 Constitution saving throw or be paralyzed for 1 minute. The target repeats the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on a success.

Hungry Lunge (Recharge 5–6). This ghoul moves up to half its speed without provoking opportunity attacks. If it ends this movement adjacent to a paralyzed, incapacitated, or unconscious creature, it makes one claw attack against that creature.

- This ghoul attacks from just beyond normal melee reach.
- It often stands behind other ghouls, striking over them.
- Once prey falls, it lurches forward to claim the corpse.



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